How the Forever Character Oracle chooses

The mathematics behind the class, specialization and confidence figures · version 1.6.0 · algorithm 1.4.0 · November 3, 2026

This document explains every calculation that turns your answers into a recommendation, and every number behind it. Each table is computed from the quiz's live configuration and from seeded simulations, so it can be regenerated whenever the weights change (`python tools/build_math_pdf.py`). Scores are **relative compatibility indicators, not probabilities**; the only probabilities in this document are the ones in the confidence model (section 8), which are exact *within that model* and rest on assumptions stated there. The quiz is playstyle lore, not a personality science: studies of WoW players found little or no link between personality and class choice.

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1 The pipeline in one page

Every question has a finite set of **responses** (an answer, a pair, an ordering, a split of points, a rating). Each response carries weights for the nine classes, the twelve personality traits and, for some answers, individual specializations. The weights of the response you give are added up over the questions, after subtracting what an average response would have contributed, so that a question can never favour a class just by appearing in the quiz.

$$\text{answers} \rightarrow \text{response weights} \rightarrow \Delta\ (\text{minus the average}) \rightarrow S_c,\ T_t \rightarrow P_s \rightarrow \text{result}$$

Step	What is computed	Section
1	the response you gave becomes a weight vector (classes, traits, specializations)	2
2	the average weight over all possible responses is subtracted	3
3	class scores S_c and trait scores T_t are the sums of those differences over the questions	4
4	the class with the largest S_c wins; ties go to a fixed class order	4
5	inside the winning class, specialization scores P_s combine the trait scores with the specialization's profile and any direct weights; the largest wins	5
6	the gap between the top two classes becomes a label (Strong lean, Clear lean, Close call)	6
7	optionally, a probabilistic model reads the same numbers as evidence and gives a confidence	8

2 Questions and responses

A question's *answers* (up to four) carry the weights. What you submit is a *response*; its weights are a fixed linear combination of its answers' weights, with a coefficient for each answer:

$$w_q(r,k) = \sum_a \gamma_q(r,a)\ w_{q,a}(k) \qquad k \in \{\text{classes},\ \text{traits},\ \text{specializations}\}$$

Type	You do	Responses R	Coefficients γ(r, a)	Questions
choice	pick one answer	number of answers (2 or 4)	1 for the chosen answer, 0 for the others	14
pick two	choose two of four	6 pairs	1 for each of the two chosen answers	2
ranking	order the four	24 orderings	(3 − place)/2: 1.5, 1, 0.5, 0 from first to last	3
allocation	spend 6 points on four items	84 splits	points / 3 (so six points on one item counts 2)	3
scale	rate 1 to 10	10 ratings	max(s,0) for 'agree', max(−s,0) for 'disagree', s = (rating − 5.5)/4.5	8

Table 1. The five question types. Response counts are exact; the weights a response carries follow from the coefficients.

3 Baseline subtraction

Some classes appear in more answers than others, and a question with many responses would otherwise add more than a short one. So each question's contribution is measured against its own average over **every possible response** (R_q of them):

$$\Delta_q(r,k) = w_q(r,k) - \frac{1}{R_q}\sum_{r'=1}^{R_q} w_q(r',k)$$

Two consequences hold for every question and every class, trait and specialization: the contributions average to zero over the responses (so no question favours anything on average), and, because every answer carries a class weight of 2 + 1 (or another split of 3), the class contributions of any single response add up to zero, so the nine class scores of a complete answer set sum to zero. They are comparisons with the average answer pattern, not amounts.

Worked example, question 1. “You are permitted to spend one evening in an unfamiliar estate. Which room attracts you first?” Answer A is “The conservatory, filled with plants from distant countries.” Its class weights, the average over the four answers, and what choosing A contributes:

Class	Raw weight of A	Average over A–D	Δ for response A
Druid	2.00	0.50	+1.50
Hunter	1.00	0.25	+0.75
Mage	0.00	0.50	-0.50
Paladin	0.00	0.25	-0.25
Priest	0.00	0.50	-0.50
Rogue	0.00	0.25	-0.25
Shaman	0.00	0.25	-0.25
Warlock	0.00	0.50	-0.50

Table 2. Baseline subtraction for question 1, response A. The contributions of the nine classes add up to 0.00.

Worked example, a point-spending question. Question 9 asks how to divide six hours at a festival; the response “3-0-0-3” spends three points on the first item and three on the last. Its coefficients are 1, 0, 0, 1, so its class weights are the sums of those two answers' weights:

Class	Raw	Average over 84 splits	Δ
Hunter	1.750	1.875	-0.125
Paladin	0.000	0.500	-0.500
Priest	0.000	0.500	-0.500
Rogue	1.250	0.625	+0.625
Shaman	2.000	1.000	+1.000
Warlock	0.000	1.000	-1.000
Warrior	1.000	0.500	+0.500

Table 3. Baseline subtraction for a response with 84 possible values.

4 Class and trait scores, and the winning class

Over the answered questions q, the class score and the trait score are the sums of the differences. The class with the largest score is recommended; scores are compared after rounding to nine decimals, and exact ties fall to the class order below.

$$S_c = \sum_q \Delta_q(r_q, c) \qquad T_t = \sum_q \Delta_q(r_q, t) \qquad c^* = \arg\max_c S_c$$

Tie-break order: Druid, Hunter, Mage, Paladin, Priest, Rogue, Shaman, Warlock, Warrior. Sums are computed exactly (Shewchuk summation), so float noise never decides a result. The browser version of the engine reproduces the Python one to the last digit; a test compares them on every build.

5 Specialization scores

Only the winning class's specializations compete. A specialization s has a **profile**: an ordered list of traits with multipliers (1.5, 1.0 and 0.45 for its primary, secondary and tertiary trait). Its score adds the profile-weighted trait scores to the sum of any **direct specialization weights** that answers carry, scaled by the multiplier M = 5:

$$P_s = \sum_t m_{s,t} T_t \; + \; M \sum_q \Delta_q^{\text{spec}}(r_q, s) \qquad s^* = \arg\max_{s \in c^*} P_s$$

Class	Specialization	Primary trait ×1.5	Secondary ×1.0	Tertiary ×0.45
Druid	Balance	Curiosity	Intuition	Precision
Druid	Feral Combat	Intuition	Spontaneity	Independence
Druid	Restoration	Compassion	Loyalty	Protectiveness
Hunter	Beast Mastery	Loyalty	Intuition	Protectiveness
Hunter	Marksmanship	Precision	Independence	Curiosity
Hunter	Survival	Spontaneity	Ingenuity	Intuition
Mage	Arcane	Curiosity	Precision	Mystery
Mage	Fire	Intensity	Spontaneity	Independence
Mage	Frost	Precision	Protectiveness	Curiosity
Paladin	Holy	Compassion	Conviction	Loyalty
Paladin	Protection	Protectiveness	Conviction	Precision
Paladin	Retribution	Conviction	Intensity	Spontaneity
Priest	Discipline	Precision	Compassion	Curiosity
Priest	Holy	Compassion	Loyalty	Conviction
Priest	Shadow	Mystery	Curiosity	Intensity
Rogue	Assassination	Precision	Mystery	Spontaneity
Rogue	Combat	Spontaneity	Intensity	Independence
Rogue	Subtlety	Ingenuity	Mystery	Precision
Shaman	Elemental Combat	Intensity	Intuition	Curiosity
Shaman	Enhancement	Spontaneity	Conviction	Intensity
Shaman	Restoration	Compassion	Intuition	Loyalty
Warlock	Affliction	Mystery	Precision	Curiosity
Warlock	Demonology	Loyalty	Mystery	Protectiveness
Warlock	Destruction	Intensity	Mystery	Spontaneity
Warrior	Arms	Precision	Conviction	Spontaneity
Warrior	Fury	Intensity	Spontaneity	Independence
Warrior	Protection	Protectiveness	Conviction	Loyalty

Table 4. The 27 specialization profiles. A trait's multiplier is its position's value; direct weights are listed in Appendix B.

59 of the 98 answers carry direct specialization weights. They exist because the trait profiles alone could not make some specializations win at all: with the original sixteen questions, a search found no answers that reached Mage Frost or Rogue Assassination. With M = 5 and the direct weights every specialization can be reached, and the tuning described in section 7 keeps them all reachable, and each winning a healthy share, at every quiz length.

6 Reading the gap: labels and margins

The label shown with a result is a heuristic about the gap G between the top two class scores. It is not a statistical estimate.

$$G = S_{(1)} - S_{(2)} \qquad \text{Strong lean}: \; G \geq \mu_s\sqrt{n/N} \qquad \text{Clear lean}: \; G \geq \mu_c\sqrt{n/N} \qquad \text{otherwise Close call}$$

Here $\mu_s = 3$ and $\mu_c = 1.25$ are the configured margins for the full 30-question quiz (N = 30), and n is the number of questions actually answered. The gap between the two best classes of random answers grows roughly like √n, so scaling the margins by √(n/N) keeps a short quiz from being called a “close call” merely for being short. A test checks that the share of each label under random answers stays comparable across lengths.

Questions n	Strong lean at G ≥	Clear lean at G ≥
10	1.732	0.722
15	2.121	0.884
20	2.449	1.021
25	2.739	1.141
30	3.000	1.250

Table 5. Margins by number of questions answered.

7 Quiz lengths and balance under random answers

The quiz can be taken at three fixed lengths. The sets of questions are nested (short ⊂ medium ⊂ long), so a short result can be sharpened by answering the next ten questions. A fixed length scores only its own questions; everything else is unchanged.

Length	Questions	choice	scale	pick two	ranking	allocation	Top-two gap quartiles (25 / 50 / 75 / 90%)
short	10	4	3	1	1	1	0.42 / 0.95 / 1.76 / 2.67
medium	20	8	7	1	2	2	0.56 / 1.29 / 2.39 / 3.66
long	30	14	8	2	3	3	0.69 / 1.57 / 2.92 / 4.46

Table 6. Composition of each length, and the gap G between the top two class scores for 100,000 uniformly random answer sets.

What “equal” means. The quiz is balanced so that, if every response to every question were equally likely, every class would be recommended equally often and every specialization would win a healthy share of its class's results. This is a property of the scoring rules, measured by simulation; it says nothing about how people really answer. With n simulated runs a share p has standard error √(p(1−p)/n):

$$\mathrm{SE}(p) = \sqrt{p(1-p)/n} \qquad \text{e.g.} \quad p = \tfrac{1}{9},\ n = 100{,}000: \quad \mathrm{SE} \approx 0.10\%$$

Class	Short share	Medium share	Long share
Druid	11.17%	11.15%	11.12%
Hunter	10.86%	11.19%	11.13%
Mage	11.42%	11.12%	11.20%
Paladin	11.01%	11.02%	11.06%
Priest	11.42%	11.23%	11.06%
Rogue	11.09%	10.98%	11.05%
Shaman	10.81%	11.16%	11.13%
Warlock	10.94%	11.15%	11.07%
Warrior	11.28%	10.99%	11.17%
Even split	11.11%	11.11%	11.11%

Table 7. How often each class is recommended under uniformly random answers (100,000 runs per length, seed 4242).

Class	Specialization	Short	Medium	Long
Druid	Balance	47.9%	35.3%	32.6%
Druid	Feral Combat	24.1%	38.0%	27.7%
Druid	Restoration	28.1%	26.7%	39.7%
Hunter	Beast Mastery	28.3%	34.6%	35.2%
Hunter	Marksmanship	29.7%	34.1%	34.0%
Hunter	Survival	42.0%	31.4%	30.8%
Mage	Arcane	27.0%	33.7%	34.9%
Mage	Fire	36.6%	36.1%	26.9%
Mage	Frost	36.4%	30.2%	38.2%
Paladin	Holy	44.1%	34.2%	31.0%
Paladin	Protection	31.1%	38.4%	40.1%
Paladin	Retribution	24.7%	27.5%	28.9%
Priest	Discipline	34.5%	44.3%	33.4%
Priest	Holy	28.0%	30.6%	40.9%
Priest	Shadow	37.5%	25.1%	25.7%
Rogue	Assassination	28.5%	28.6%	34.3%
Rogue	Combat	39.7%	43.9%	31.5%
Rogue	Subtlety	31.8%	27.5%	34.2%
Shaman	Elemental Combat	30.9%	34.5%	28.6%
Shaman	Enhancement	39.0%	34.8%	31.4%
Shaman	Restoration	30.1%	30.8%	39.9%
Warlock	Affliction	30.5%	41.9%	37.2%
Warlock	Demonology	31.5%	32.4%	38.9%
Warlock	Destruction	38.0%	25.7%	23.8%
Warrior	Arms	34.1%	43.1%	38.3%
Warrior	Fury	35.3%	30.0%	35.9%
Warrior	Protection	30.7%	27.0%	25.9%

Table 8. The share of its class's recommendations each specialization wins under random answers. The requirement is at least 20%; the lowest values are 24.1% (short), 25.1% (medium) and 23.8% (long).

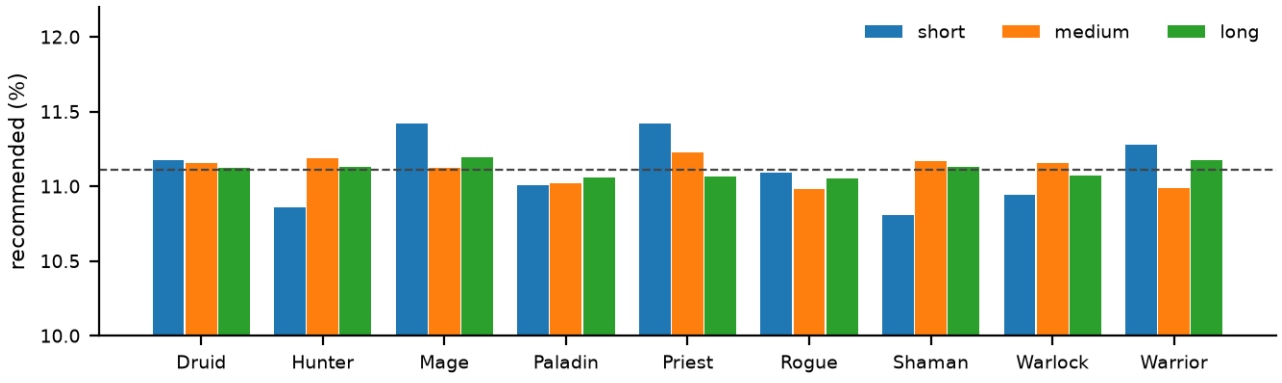


Figure 1. Class shares under random answers; the dashed line is an even 11.11%. Differences of a few tenths of a point are within what the weights can be tuned to and the noise of the simulation.

8 Confidence mode: asking until the Oracle is sure

In confidence mode (the default) the Oracle chooses each next question to learn as much as possible, and stops once it is confident in one specialization: after at least 10 questions, as soon as the model's probability for the recommended specialization reaches 90%, and never after more than 30. To say "probability" at all we need a model of how a person of each type answers. The model below is deliberately built from the quiz's own numbers.

8.1 The choice model

There are 27 **types** τ = (class c, specialization s). A person of type τ is assumed to answer question q by a *logit choice*: each response r has a utility equal to what it contributes to that type's scores, and responses are picked with probability proportional to exp(utility).

$$u_q(r \mid \tau) = \lambda_c \, \Delta_q(r, c) + \lambda_s \left(\sum_t m_{s,t} \, \Delta_q(r, t) + M \, \Delta_q^{\text{spec}}(r, s) \right)$$

$$P(r \mid \tau, q) = \frac{e^{\,u_q(r|\tau)}}{\sum_{r'} e^{\,u_q(r'|\tau)}}$$

The sharpness constants say how consistently people answer as their type: $\lambda_c = 1$ and $\lambda_s = 0.35$. Larger values mean answers reveal the type more reliably, so fewer questions are needed. They are assumptions (section 10), chosen so that a simulated respondent needs about 16 questions on average (and a few need all 30), and they can be changed in the admin settings.

8.2 The posterior

Questions are answered independently given the type, and every type starts equally likely (1/27). Bayes' rule gives the probability of each type after the answers $r_1 \ldots r_n$:

$$\pi(\tau \mid r_{1:n}) = \frac{\prod_{i=1}^{n} P(r_i \mid \tau, q_i)}{\sum_{\tau'} \prod_{i=1}^{n} P(r_i \mid \tau', q_i)}$$

$$\ln \pi(\tau \mid r_{1:n}) = \lambda_c S_c + \lambda_s P_s - \sum_{i=1}^{n} \ln Z_{q_i}(\tau) + \text{const.} \qquad Z_q(\tau) = \sum_r e^{\,u_q(r|\tau)}$$

The first two terms are the quiz's own class and specialization scores: **the scoring is the evidence, and the model turns it into probabilities**. The normalizers $\ln Z_q(\tau)$ correct for how strongly each type prefers particular responses to a question. A test verifies this identity numerically. Before any answer the uncertainty is the entropy $H = \ln 27 = 3.296$ nats; the confidence is the posterior probability of the specialization the scoring currently recommends (class first, then specialization), not of the posterior's own maximum, so the recommendation shown and the confidence stated always refer to the same specialization. One visible consequence: when a new answer changes which specialization leads, the certainty meter can fall before it rises again.

8.3 Choosing the next question

For each unanswered question the Oracle computes the **expected information gain**: how much, on average, the answer would reduce the uncertainty about the type. It asks the question with the largest gain (ties go to the earlier question; gains are compared after rounding to nine decimals).

$$H(\pi) = -\sum_{\tau} \pi(\tau) \ln \pi(\tau) \qquad \mathrm{IG}(q) = H(\pi) - \sum_{r} P(r \mid q)\, H(\pi(\cdot \mid r)) \qquad P(r \mid q) = \sum_{\tau} \pi(\tau)\, P(r \mid \tau, q)$$

Rank	Question	Type	Information gain (nats)	Of the maximum ln 27
1	Q09	allocation	0.591	17.9%
2	Q26	ranking	0.560	17.0%
3	Q03	allocation	0.535	16.2%
4	Q13	choice	0.532	16.1%
5	Q01	choice	0.503	15.2%
6	Q15	allocation	0.502	15.2%
7	Q04	choice	0.462	14.0%
8	Q07	ranking	0.442	13.4%

Table 9. The eight most informative first questions (before any answer). The Oracle always opens with the first one; what it asks next depends on your answers.

8.4 When to stop

$$\text{stop when} \quad n \geq n_{\min} \quad \text{and} \quad \pi(\hat{\tau} \mid r_{1:n}) \geq \theta \quad \text{or} \quad n \geq n_{\max}, \qquad \hat{\tau} = \text{recommended specialization}$$

Setting	Symbol	Value	Meaning
Minimum questions	n_{min}	10	never reveal earlier
Maximum questions	n_{max}	30	reveal anyway (a “Close call” is possible)
Confidence threshold	θ	90%	probability the model must give the recommendation
Class sharpness	λ_c	1	how strongly class weights steer an answer
Specialization sharpness	λ_s	0.35	how strongly a profile steers an answer

Table 10. Confidence-mode settings (admin: Profiles & Settings).

8.5 What to expect: simulated respondents

To see how the procedure behaves, 400 simulated people were generated for each row: a type is drawn uniformly, then they answer every question the Oracle asks as the model says that type would. The numbers are exact consequences of the assumptions, not measurements of real people.

Question order	Mean questions	Median	90th percentile	Reached the limit	Mean stop confidence	Right type at stop
adaptive (information gain)	15.8	11	30	20%	86.1%	85.8%
fixed (quiz order)	20.7	19	30	26%	84.6%	84.2%

Table 11. Adaptive question choice versus asking in quiz order, under the model. Choosing questions by information gain saves several questions.

Because the posterior is exact within the model, the stated confidence should match how often the recommendation is right among simulated people who stop with that confidence. It does, up to sampling noise:

Stop confidence	Runs	Mean stated confidence	Actually right
0.00 – 0.80	68	46.7%	48.5%
0.80 – 0.90	14	84.3%	78.6%
0.90 – 0.95	180	92.2%	92.2%
0.95 – 0.99	95	97.1%	94.7%
0.99 – 1.00	43	99.5%	100.0%

Table 12. Calibration inside the model. This checks the arithmetic, not the model: real people are not guaranteed to answer like the model's.

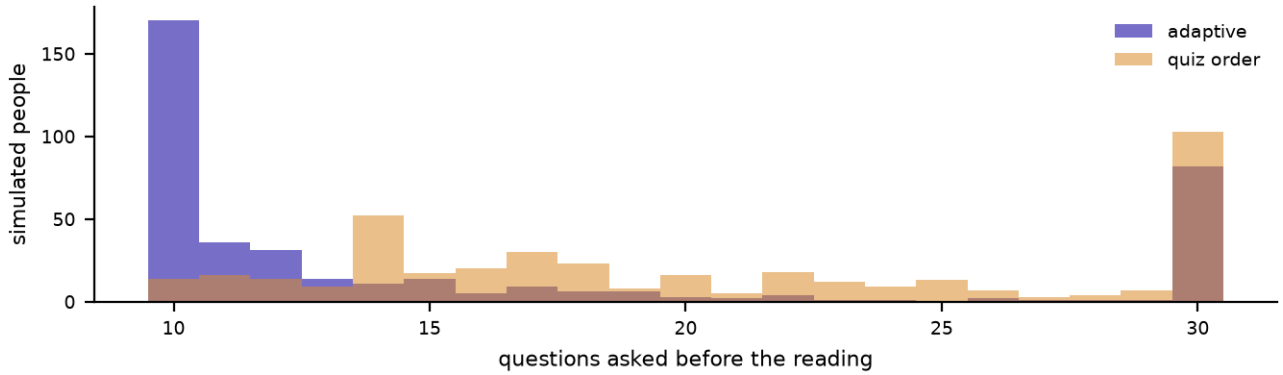


Figure 2. How many questions simulated respondents are asked.

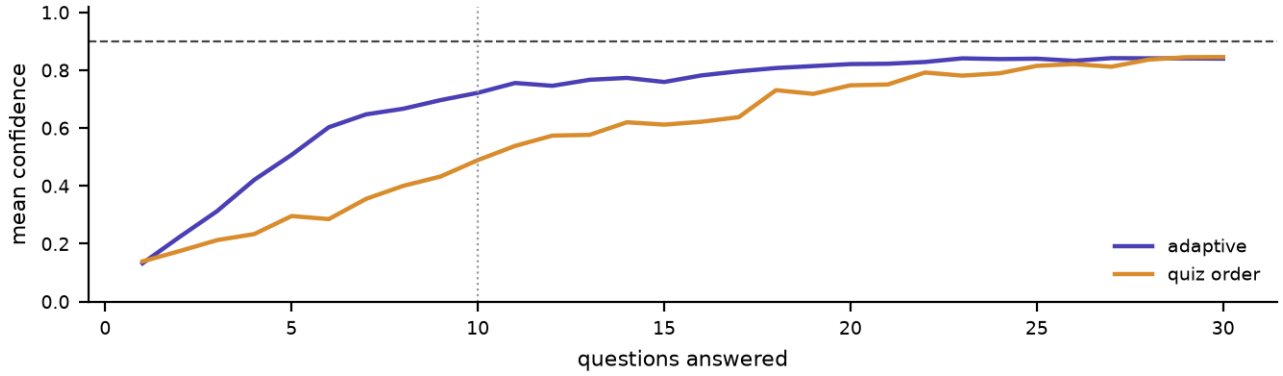


Figure 3. Mean confidence after each question for simulated respondents (all 30 questions asked). Dashed: the 90% threshold; dotted: the minimum of 10.

After n questions	Uncertainty H, adaptive (nats)	H, quiz order (nats)	Confidence, adaptive	Confidence, quiz order
0	3.296	3.296	3.7%	3.7%
1	2.694	2.795	13.2%	13.9%
3	1.702	2.237	31.3%	21.2%
5	1.071	1.723	50.7%	29.6%
8	0.688	1.301	66.7%	40.0%
10	0.548	1.050	72.2%	48.9%
12	0.464	0.850	74.6%	57.4%
15	0.390	0.607	75.9%	61.2%
20	0.294	0.402	82.1%	74.8%
25	0.273	0.310	84.0%	81.5%
30	0.263	0.259	84.0%	84.5%

Table 13. Average uncertainty and confidence by number of questions, for simulated respondents.

8.6 How much the assumptions matter

The sharpness constant is the one number that is a pure assumption. A larger value assumes answers reveal the type more clearly, so the Oracle needs fewer questions and reaches its threshold more easily; a smaller value assumes noisier answers and asks for more. If real people are noisier than the default assumes, the true accuracy at a stated 90% is lower than 90%.

λ_s (specialization sharpness)	Mean questions	Median	Reached the limit	Mean stop confidence	Right type at stop
0.2	24.0	30	60%	72.5%	72.5%
0.25	19.7	16	38%	79.4%	81.0%
0.3	17.6	12	30%	82.8%	81.5%
0.35 (default)	16.3	12	23%	84.3%	83.2%
0.4	15.0	11	18%	87.7%	87.8%
0.5	13.2	10	10%	90.7%	91.5%

Table 14. Effect of the specialization sharpness (λ_c held at its default), simulated respondents.

Confidence threshold θ	Mean questions	Median	Reached the limit	Mean stop confidence	Right type at stop
80%	13.9	10	11%	85.1%	85.8%
90% (default)	16.1	11	22%	85.5%	86.2%
95%	18.1	14	30%	85.6%	83.8%
99%	23.4	30	56%	83.8%	85.2%

Table 15. The trade between certainty and length: higher thresholds ask more questions and are right more often.

People who answer at random. With no consistent type there is nothing to find: under uniformly random answers the mean stop is 24.5 questions, 58% of such respondents run to the limit of 30, and the final reading has a typical confidence of 58%. The result is then reported with a lower confidence and a weaker label, which is the intended behaviour.

9 A worked example

A fixed example respondent (the same answer set used in the tests) taking the quiz in confidence mode. At each step the table shows which question the Oracle chose, the response, how much information it expected from it, and where the posterior stood after the answer.

n	Question	Type	Response	Expected gain (nats)	Recommended after answering	Confidence	H (nats)
1	Q09	allocation	`3-0-0-3`	0.591	Shaman Enhancement	0.3%	2.948
2	Q26	ranking	`a>b>c>d`	0.639	Hunter Survival	21.4%	2.281
3	Q03	allocation	`0-0-6-0`	0.594	Druid Feral Combat	75.2%	0.819
4	Q22	scale	`10`	0.149	Druid Feral Combat	87.8%	0.474
5	Q06	choice	`d`	0.055	Druid Feral Combat	91.0%	0.363
6	Q15	allocation	`3-3-0-0`	0.032	Druid Feral Combat	95.5%	0.217
7	Q27	pick two	`b+d`	0.020	Druid Feral Combat	96.5%	0.173
8	Q23	scale	`1`	0.011	Druid Feral Combat	93.2%	0.293
9	Q02	choice	`c`	0.024	Druid Feral Combat	89.7%	0.380
10	Q13	choice	`d`	0.028	Druid Feral Combat	97.3%	0.145

Table 16. The example run stops after 10 questions with 97.3% confidence in Druid Feral Combat. The five most probable types at the end:

Type	Probability
Druid Feral Combat	97.25%
Druid Balance	1.48%
Druid Restoration	1.26%
Rogue Assassination	0.00%
Rogue Combat	0.00%

The deterministic result for the same 10 answers: Druid – Feral Combat; top-two class gap G = 6.79; label “Strong lean” (margins 1.73 / 0.72).

10 Assumptions and limits

• **Scores are relative.** A class score is a sum of differences from the average answer pattern. “+13” does not mean 13% or 13 of anything. The nine class scores of a complete answer set sum to zero.

• **The weights are judgement.** Which answers point to which classes comes from playstyle lore and the project's own reading of Blizzard's class descriptions, not from data. Research on WoW players has found little or no link between personality and the class they choose.

• **Balance is a property of the rules.** “Every class equally likely” holds when every response is equally likely. Real answers are not uniform, so real results will not be evenly spread, and nothing here claims they should be.

• **The confidence is exact inside a model, and the model is an assumption.** It says: people of a type answer by a logit choice with sharpness λ, independently, from a uniform start. Real answers are correlated and noisier or sharper than any one λ. Treat “90% sure” as “the answers are as consistent with one specialization as this model requires”, not as a measured accuracy.

• **Talent builds are drafts.** The builds shown with a result come from hand-assembled talent data dated November 2, 2026 and are unverified; they play no part in the selection.

• **Reproducibility.** Everything above is deterministic given the configuration; the simulations use fixed seeds. The browser and Python engines are tested to give identical results.

Appendix A The questions

Id	Type	Responses	Shortest quiz asking it	Question
Q01	choice	4	short	You are permitted to spend one evening in an unfamiliar estate. Which room attracts you first?
Q02	choice	4	medium	Someone you care about has been treated unfairly. What is your immediate response?
Q17	scale	10	medium	When a group is lost, I'm the one who steps forward and decides.
Q03	allocation	84	medium	You arrive alone in an unfamiliar city with six hours to spare. How do you divide them among these places?
Q04	choice	4	medium	A mysterious event occurs. Which would you find most compelling?
Q25	pick two	6	long	You can carry only two of these on a long road. Which two do you take?
Q05	choice	4	long	An important plan has failed unexpectedly. How do you respond?
Q18	scale	10	medium	I plan every step before I begin, rather than working it out as I go.
Q06	choice	4	short	You are offered one unusual gift. Which would you accept?
Q07	ranking	24	long	Rank these kinds of weather from the one you would most like to the one you would least like.
Q19	scale	10	short	I will gladly gamble a lot for the chance of a big reward.
Q08	choice	4	long	If people remembered you for one quality, which would you choose?
Q28	choice	2	long	Which would you rather be?
Q09	allocation	84	short	You have six hours at a large festival. How do you divide them among these places?
Q20	scale	10	medium	I do my best work at a steady, unhurried pace.
Q10	choice	4	long	You may possess an extraordinary ability, provided you accept its limitation. Which do you choose?
Q26	ranking	24	medium	Four travelling companions ask to join you. Rank them from the one you would welcome most gladly to the one you would…
Q11	ranking	24	short	Rank these objects from the one you would most want to preserve for its beauty to the one you would least.
Q21	scale	10	long	I do my best when someone loyal is at my side.
Q12	choice	4	short	Which characteristic in other people frustrates you most?
Q29	choice	2	long	A stubborn locked gate stands between you and what you need. What do you do?
Q13	choice	4	short	If you disappeared from your ordinary life for a month, what would you most likely be doing?
Q22	scale	10	medium	I would rather learn from the wild than from books.
Q14	choice	4	medium	When two friends disagree, what position do you naturally assume?
Q27	pick two	6	short	A storm is rolling in. Which two things do you do?
Q15	allocation	84	long	After an exceptionally difficult day you have six hours to yourself. How do you spend them?
Q23	scale	10	short	I enjoy being noticed when I do something well.
Q16	choice	4	medium	Finally, choose the symbol that appeals to you most, without explaining why.
Q24	scale	10	short	I enjoy juggling many things at once and keeping them all going.
Q30	choice	2	long	Which fire would you rather tend?

Appendix B Answer weights

Class weights always add up to 3 for an answer (usually 2 and 1; some are adjusted by a quarter point to equalize the classes); trait weights are 2 and 1; “direct” lists specialization weights (multiplied by M in P_s). For a scale question the two answers are the “agree” and “disagree” poles. 12 traits: Intuition (wild), Curiosity (scholar), Conviction (duty), Mystery (shadow), Protectiveness (guardian), Precision (focus), Compassion (healer), Intensity (power), Ingenuity (trickster), Spontaneity (instinct), Loyalty (bond), Independence (freedom).

Answer	Class weights	Trait weights	Direct specialization weights
Q01/a	Druid 2, Hunter 1	Intuition 2, Compassion 1	Druid Restoration 2
Q01/b	Mage 2, Shaman 1	Curiosity 2, Precision 1	Mage Frost 1
Q01/c	Priest 2, Paladin 1	Conviction 2, Protectiveness 1	Paladin Retribution 1
Q01/d	Warlock 2, Rogue 1	Mystery 2, Curiosity 1	Rogue Assassination 1, Warlock Demonology 1
Q02/a	Paladin 2, Warrior 1	Protectiveness 2, Conviction 1	–
Q02/b	Mage 2, Hunter 1	Precision 2, Curiosity 1	–
Q02/c	Priest 2, Druid 1	Compassion 2, Loyalty 1	Druid Restoration 1
Q02/d	Warlock 2, Shaman 1	Mystery 2, Intensity 1	–
Q17/agree	Warrior 1.5, Paladin 1.5	Protectiveness 2, Intensity 1	Paladin Protection 1, Warrior Protection 2
Q17/disagree	Hunter 2, Rogue 1	Independence 2, Precision 1	Hunter Marksmanship 2, Rogue Assassination 2
Q03/a	Hunter 2, Rogue 1	Ingenuity 2, Independence 1	–
Q03/b	Warrior 2, Shaman 1	Spontaneity 2, Loyalty 1	–
Q03/c	Druid 2, Priest 1	Intuition 2, Compassion 1	–
Q03/d	Mage 1.75, Warlock 1.25	Curiosity 2, Mystery 1	Warlock Demonology 2
Q04/a	Hunter 2, Druid 1	Intuition 2, Spontaneity 1	–
Q04/b	Shaman 2, Mage 1	Intensity 2, Intuition 1	Mage Fire 3
Q04/c	Paladin 2.5, Priest 0.5	Conviction 2, Precision 1	–
Q04/d	Rogue 2, Warlock 1	Mystery 2, Ingenuity 1	–
Q25/a	Paladin 2.25, Warrior 0.75	Protectiveness 2, Conviction 1	Paladin Holy 1, Paladin Protection 2, Warrior Arms 1
Q25/b	Druid 1.75, Shaman 1.25	Compassion 2, Intuition 1	Druid Balance 1, Druid Feral Combat 1, Druid Restoration 2, Shaman Restoration 1
Q25/c	Rogue 2, Warlock 1	Ingenuity 2, Mystery 1	Rogue Combat 1, Rogue Subtlety 2
Q25/d	Mage 1.5, Warlock 1.5	Curiosity 2, Precision 1	Warlock Affliction 1
Q05/a	Hunter 2.5, Rogue 0.5	Ingenuity 2, Spontaneity 1	–
Q05/b	Warrior 2.25, Paladin 0.75	Protectiveness 2, Intensity 1	–
Q05/c	Shaman 2.5, Druid 0.5	Intuition 2, Spontaneity 1	Druid Balance 1
Q05/d	Mage 1.5, Warlock 1.5	Curiosity 2, Precision 1	–
Q18/agree	Warlock 2, Mage 1	Precision 2, Curiosity 1	Mage Arcane 2, Mage Frost 2, Warlock Affliction 1
Q18/disagree	Shaman 2, Rogue 1	Spontaneity 2, Ingenuity 1	Rogue Combat 2, Shaman Enhancement 1
Q06/a	Hunter 2, Warlock 1	Loyalty 2, Intuition 1	–
Q06/b	Paladin 1.75, Priest 1.25	Conviction 2, Compassion 1	–
Q06/c	Mage 2, Rogue 1	Curiosity 2, Mystery 1	–
Q06/d	Druid 2, Shaman 1	Intuition 2, Independence 1	Druid Feral Combat 1
Q07/a	Mage 1.75, Priest 1.25	Precision 2, Protectiveness 1	Mage Frost 1
Q07/b	Druid 2, Shaman 1	Compassion 2, Intuition 1	Druid Balance 1
Q07/c	Warrior 2.5, Shaman 0.5	Intensity 2, Spontaneity 1	–
Q07/d	Rogue 1.75, Warlock 1.25	Mystery 2, Ingenuity 1	–
Q19/agree	Warlock 1.75, Mage 1.25	Intensity 2, Spontaneity 1	Mage Fire 3, Warlock Destruction 2
Q19/disagree	Priest 2, Paladin 1	Protectiveness 2, Precision 1	Paladin Holy 1, Paladin Protection 1, Priest Discipline 2

Answer	Class weights	Trait weights	Direct specialization weights
Q08/a	Paladin 2, Warrior 1	Protectiveness 2, Conviction 1	Paladin Holy 1
Q08/b	Mage 1.75, Rogue 1.25	Precision 2, Curiosity 1	–
Q08/c	Priest 2, Druid 1	Compassion 2, Loyalty 1	–
Q08/d	Warlock 1.5, Hunter 1.5	Intensity 2, Independence 1	Hunter Marksmanship 1
Q28/a	Priest 1.5, Paladin 1.5	Compassion 2, Protectiveness 1	Paladin Holy 1, Priest Holy 2
Q28/b	Rogue 1.5, Warrior 1.5	Mystery 2, Spontaneity 1	Rogue Combat 2, Warrior Fury 1
Q09/a	Shaman 2, Warrior 1	Spontaneity 2, Intensity 1	Shaman Enhancement 2, Warrior Arms 1
Q09/b	Warlock 2, Priest 1	Mystery 2, Curiosity 1	Priest Shadow 3
Q09/c	Hunter 2, Paladin 1	Loyalty 2, Protectiveness 1	Hunter Beast Mastery 1
Q09/d	Hunter 1.75, Rogue 1.25	Ingenuity 2, Intuition 1	–
Q20/agree	Warlock 2, Druid 1	Precision 2, Intuition 1	Druid Balance 1, Warlock Affliction 2
Q20/disagree	Warrior 2.5, Shaman 0.5	Spontaneity 2, Intensity 1	Shaman Enhancement 1, Warrior Fury 2
Q10/a	Druid 2, Hunter 1	Intuition 2, Loyalty 1	–
Q10/b	Rogue 1.75, Hunter 1.25	Precision 2, Ingenuity 1	Rogue Assassination 3
Q10/c	Priest 2, Paladin 1	Compassion 2, Conviction 1	–
Q10/d	Warlock 1.75, Shaman 1.25	Mystery 2, Intensity 1	–
Q26/a	Hunter 2, Druid 1	Loyalty 2, Intuition 1	Druid Feral Combat 1, Druid Restoration 1, Hunter Beast Mastery 1
Q26/b	Rogue 2, Warlock 1	Ingenuity 2, Spontaneity 1	Rogue Combat 2, Warlock Demonology 1
Q26/c	Warrior 2, Paladin 1	Conviction 2, Protectiveness 1	Paladin Retribution 1, Warrior Arms 3, Warrior Protection 1
Q26/d	Priest 1.5, Shaman 1.5	Compassion 2, Loyalty 1	Priest Discipline 2, Shaman Restoration 1
Q11/a	Mage 2, Paladin 1	Precision 2, Curiosity 1	–
Q11/b	Druid 2.25, Warlock 0.75	Intuition 2, Mystery 1	Druid Balance 3
Q11/c	Warrior 2, Hunter 1	Protectiveness 2, Spontaneity 1	Warrior Arms 1
Q11/d	Rogue 2, Priest 1	Ingenuity 2, Compassion 1	–
Q21/agree	Hunter 2, Warlock 1	Loyalty 2, Intuition 1	Hunter Beast Mastery 2, Warlock Demonology 1
Q21/disagree	Rogue 1.5, Hunter 1.5	Independence 2, Mystery 1	Hunter Survival 1, Rogue Assassination 1, Rogue Combat 1, Rogue Subtlety 2
Q12/a	Paladin 2, Priest 1	Protectiveness 2, Conviction 1	Paladin Protection 1
Q12/b	Warrior 2, Shaman 1	Intensity 2, Spontaneity 1	–
Q12/c	Warlock 2, Mage 1	Curiosity 2, Precision 1	–
Q12/d	Rogue 2, Hunter 1	Ingenuity 2, Independence 1	Hunter Marksmanship 1, Rogue Combat 2
Q29/a	Mage 1.75, Rogue 1.25	Curiosity 2, Precision 1	Rogue Assassination 1
Q29/b	Warlock 2, Priest 1	Intensity 2, Mystery 1	Priest Shadow 3, Warlock Demonology 2
Q13/a	Shaman 2, Druid 1	Compassion 2, Intuition 1	Druid Restoration 1, Shaman Restoration 1
Q13/b	Warrior 2, Paladin 1	Intensity 2, Conviction 1	Paladin Protection 1, Paladin Retribution 1, Warrior Arms 1
Q13/c	Priest 2.25, Mage 0.75	Curiosity 2, Precision 1	–
Q13/d	Rogue 2, Warlock 1	Mystery 2, Independence 1	Rogue Assassination 1
Q22/agree	Druid 2, Shaman 1	Intuition 2, Spontaneity 1	Druid Feral Combat 2, Shaman Elemental Combat 1
Q22/disagree	Mage 2, Priest 1	Curiosity 2, Precision 1	Priest Discipline 1
Q14/a	Priest 2, Druid 1	Compassion 2, Loyalty 1	–
Q14/b	Paladin 2, Warrior 1	Conviction 2, Protectiveness 1	–
Q14/c	Mage 2, Rogue 1	Precision 2, Curiosity 1	–
Q14/d	Warlock 2, Shaman 1	Mystery 2, Intensity 1	–
Q27/a	Shaman 2, Hunter 1	Intensity 2, Intuition 1	Shaman Elemental Combat 2

Answer	Class weights	Trait weights	Direct specialization weights
Q27/b	Paladin 2, Warrior 1	Protectiveness 2, Conviction 1	Paladin Holy 3, Warrior Protection 2
Q27/c	Hunter 2, Mage 1	Precision 2, Curiosity 1	Hunter Marksmanship 2, Mage Frost 1
Q27/d	Hunter 2, Druid 1	Ingenuity 2, Independence 1	Druid Balance 1, Druid Feral Combat 2, Hunter Survival 3
Q15/a	Hunter 2.5, Druid 0.5	Intuition 2, Independence 1	–
Q15/b	Shaman 2.5, Warrior 0.5	Loyalty 2, Spontaneity 1	–
Q15/c	Priest 2, Paladin 1	Compassion 2, Protectiveness 1	–
Q15/d	Mage 1.75, Warlock 1.25	Curiosity 2, Mystery 1	–
Q23/agree	Warrior 1.75, Mage 1.25	Intensity 2, Spontaneity 1	Mage Fire 3, Warrior Fury 2
Q23/disagree	Priest 2, Druid 1	Compassion 2, Protectiveness 1	Druid Restoration 2, Priest Discipline 1, Priest Holy 2
Q16/a	Rogue 2, Mage 1	Ingenuity 2, Precision 1	Rogue Assassination 1
Q16/b	Priest 2, Paladin 1	Compassion 2, Conviction 1	–
Q16/c	Druid 2.25, Hunter 0.75	Intuition 2, Loyalty 1	–
Q16/d	Shaman 2, Warlock 1	Intensity 2, Mystery 1	–
Q24/agree	Shaman 1.75, Warlock 1.25	Precision 2, Ingenuity 1	Shaman Restoration 2, Warlock Affliction 1, Warlock Demonology 1
Q24/disagree	Paladin 1.75, Warrior 1.25	Conviction 2, Precision 1	Paladin Retribution 2, Warrior Arms 2
Q30/a	Druid 2, Shaman 1	Compassion 2, Loyalty 1	Druid Restoration 2, Shaman Restoration 1
Q30/b	Paladin 2, Warrior 1	Conviction 2, Intensity 1	Paladin Retribution 2, Warrior Arms 1